ASSIGNMENT 7 / PRODUCTION PIPELINE AUDIT

The Suborned

Sky Rumsey | Unity 6000.6.2f1 | People, relationships and routines | Recorded generation: r016

A squad tactics game about turning ordinary people and using their relationships to take Councillor Popovic alive. Content is generated during development; no model runs during play.

01 / Production and functionality

Output: AI-generated cast tables, expanded deterministically into 130 people, 222 directed relationships and daily routines. The accepted r016 cast is promoted with its original hash. In the playable Handover, Inez Nikolaou and Arthur Reilly are lovers; Inez's debt and Arthur's relationship provide a social route past his post. Lukac and Popovic are cast from the same population.

Flow: GDD/rules retrieved through SurrealDB RAG; Pulse proposes structured cast data; deterministic checks reject defects; Keel critiques clean candidates. Promotion, people expansion, simulation export and Unity's hash-checked StreamingAssets loader require no hand reformatting. The recorded replay actually expands, exports, stages and runs the output in the retained player binary; it makes no new model call or Unity compilation.

Manual friction: a person approves cast promotion and maintains design/rule data. The shipped background projection predates the city remap; today's expansion changes some residents/stops. All four mission profiles' names, needs, temperaments and ties are verified equal. The video labels its fresh projection as a local replay variant, rather than claiming an identical public release. Publication and first-play testing remain release gates.

02 / Architectural reflection

Change: promotion pins the AI cast, but the full downstream world/people projection can survive as a stale generated file. A cast hash alone cannot reproduce a shipped population. **Alternative:** a content-addressed build manifest pinning cast, plan, block, life rules, names, needs, generator versions and every output. Build a dependency graph that regenerates affected outputs and refuses publication when an input hash differs. Keep human promotion as an explicit approval gate; automate propagation and evidence capture after it.

03 / Actual recorded run cost

r016: $0.6905 recorded usage across three calls (unrounded sum $0.6904733), including the failed first proposal. Pulse: $0.2688503 + $0.1415571; Keel: $0.2800659. The **most expensive step is Keel's final critic call**, recorded on Claude Opus; Pulse used Claude Sonnet. Amounts come from the original CLI call records, not a forecast.

These are Claude CLI total_cost_usd usage valuations on a subscription, not additional API debits or an allocated subscription invoice. The offline recording makes zero model calls. This bounded build-time approach is sustainable at this scale: reuse accepted data, cap rounds/spend and pay no runtime inference. Review labour, subscriptions, hardware, hosting and other game pipelines are excluded.

04 / Mid-project cost reduction

Before: the shared generation loop called Keel even after deterministic failure. Actual r008 rounds 1-2 incurred two such critic calls: **$0.4135186**. **After:** loop 2 (brief 007 F, 14 October) sends failed candidates directly back to their owner. Actual r016 round 1 failed P-0 and made **zero critic calls, zero critic tokens, $0 critic cost**; the corrected round received full critique. Builder/retry costs remain in the total. These are different objectives/candidates under the same framework, not an equal-work percentage benchmark.

Evidence: evidence/people.json; runs/levels/harbour-district/r016/; cast promotion record; tools/gen/rules.ts; people-run.ts. Historical model output is replayed; terminal output and player frames are captured from actual execution.

> Release gate still open: public download is macOS 0.2.231; the replay uses the 0.2.232 binary with freshly staged data. A compatible stranger's visit-to-control time of at most 120 seconds has not been certified.